ANSWER KEY

Tuesday Stations

Week 14 · Tuesday, December 15, 2026 · Practice day

Name: _____ My group: A B C D

Group	1st	2nd	3rd	4th
A	2 · SPEAK	3 · READ	4 · REVIEW GAME	1 · WARM-UP
B	3 · READ	4 · REVIEW GAME	1 · WARM-UP	2 · SPEAK
C	4 · REVIEW GAME	1 · WARM-UP	2 · SPEAK	3 · READ
D	1 · WARM-UP	2 · SPEAK	3 · READ	4 · REVIEW GAME

Station 1: WARM-UP

On your own. Check with a partner. A teacher will visit.

Pages 2–3

Station 2: SPEAK

Which is better? With a teacher.

Pages 4–5

Station 3: READ

With your group. A teacher will visit.

Pages 6–7

Station 4: REVIEW GAME

With your group. Take turns being the judge.

Pages 8–9 + game sheet on the table

How it works

- Each station is **25 minutes**. Move when the timer rings.
- **Late?** Go to **Station 1: WARM-UP**.
- **Not finished?** That's OK. Move anyway. Finish at home.
- **Finished early?** Go to the **verb charts** on page 10.
- Keep this packet. Bring it on Thursday.

ANSWER KEY

STATION 1: WARM-UP on your own

1. Fill in the blank

Use every word once. Change the word form if needed.

inflation	economy	cost of living	wages	interest rate	unemployed

1. The **cost of living** is very high here. Rent, food, and bus fares all cost a lot.
2. Why are many workers asking for higher **wages**?
3. The news said fewer people are **unemployed** this month.
4. When the **interest rate** goes up, loans cost more money.
5. **Inflation** means your paycheck doesn't go as far as it used to.
6. The news talks about the **economy** almost every day.

2. Write the form

Write the comparative or superlative. Use the words in the box.

smaller	the most expensive	better	the biggest	cheaper

1. cheap → (comparative) **cheaper**
2. expensive → (superlative) **the most expensive**
3. good → (comparative) **better**
4. big → (superlative) **the biggest**
5. small → (comparative) **smaller**

3. Compare things in your life

You make up the sentence. Use your own ideas. Many answers are OK.

Example: *The bus* is cheaper than *a taxi*. · Other good answers: *Rice* is cheaper than *meat*. · *Summer* is better than *winter*.

1. ***answers vary*** is cheaper than ***answers vary***.
2. ***answers vary*** is the best ***answers vary*** in my city.
3. Is ***answers vary*** more expensive than ***answers vary***?

ANSWER KEY

STATION 1: WARM-UP on your own

4. Verb forms: money verbs review

Write the other forms of **buy**, **sell**, and **spend**. No quiz this week. Keep this chart in your binder!

V1 base	**V1-s** he / she / it	**V-ing** -ing	**V2** past	**V3** past participle
buy	**buys**	**buying**	**bought**	**bought**
sell	**sells**	**selling**	**sold**	**sold**
spend	**spends**	**spending**	**spent**	**spent**

5. Use the right form

Look at the **bold** clue words. Write the correct form of **buy**, **sell**, or **spend**.

1. **Every week**, my family **spends** about $150 on food. (spend)
2. **Right now**, more people are **buying** used cars. (buy)
3. **Last year**, the factory didn't **sell** many cars. (sell)
4. **Yesterday**, did you **buy** eggs? They cost more now! (buy)
5. **Right now**, are families **spending** more on rent? (spend)
6. That store doesn't **sell** bread **every day**. (sell)
7. We **have** **spent** more on groceries this year. (spend)
8. **Have** they **sold** their house? (sell)

6. Bonus: Your turn

Write a true sentence about **you**. **+ not** = negative. **?** = ask a partner.

Last weekend + buy

Ideas: groceries · a gift · warm clothes · nothing!

answers vary: Last weekend, I bought a gift for my son.

A taxi + cheap **+ not** + than

Ideas: the bus · the train · walking · a bike

answers vary: A taxi isn't cheaper than the bus.

Which + the best**?**

Ideas: store for vegetables · restaurant · park · time to shop

answers vary: Which store is the best for vegetables?

ANSWER KEY

STATION 2: SPEAK Which is better? · with a teacher

Quiet *than*

The BUS is CHEAPer thn a TAXi.

than is quiet and fast: “thn.” **-er** is short.

It’s the CHEAPest store.

the is quiet. The **adjective** is loud: the **BEST**, the most ex**PEN**sive.

A. Listen: compare 2, or number 1?

Your teacher reads a sentence. Is it **-er / more … than** (2 things) or **the -est / the most** (number 1)? Circle it.

1. _____ (-er / more … than) · the -est / the most
2. _____ -er / more … than · (the -est / the most)
3. _____ (-er / more … than) · the -est / the most
4. _____ -er / more … than · (the -est / the most)
5. _____ (-er / more … than) · the -est / the most
6. _____ -er / more … than · (the -est / the most)
7. _____ (-er / more … than) · the -est / the most
8. _____ -er / more … than · (the -est / the most)

B. Which is better? Friendly debate

Choose a topic. Each person picks a side and gives **2 reasons**. Use **-er / more … than**.

City or country?	**Cook at home or eat out?**	**Bus or car?**
Summer or winter in Boston?	**A big store or a small store?**	**Call or text?**

I think the city is better **because** …
The bus is **cheaper than** a car.

Yes, but the country is quieter.
I agree. / **I don’t agree.**

ANSWER KEY

STATION 2: SPEAK Which is better? · with a teacher

C. Who is number 1 in our group?

Ask the people **at your table**. Write a name. Then write 2 sentences: *Ana has the oldest phone in our group.*

Who has the oldest phone?	
Who wakes up the earliest?	
Who has the longest bus or train ride?	
Who has the biggest family?	
Who is the best cook?	
Who lives the closest to school?	

answers vary: check the + -est / the most

D. Talk together

Answer with a **full sentence**. Then ask: *"Why?"*

1. What is the best food from your country?
2. What is the most expensive thing in Boston?
3. Is your city here bigger or smaller than your hometown?
4. What is the best time of year here? Why?

E. Say it to your teacher

Write one sentence with **-er / more ... than** and one with **the -est / the most**. Read them to your teacher.

than *answers vary*

the *answers vary*

You can say "Pass." *You never have to answer a question.*

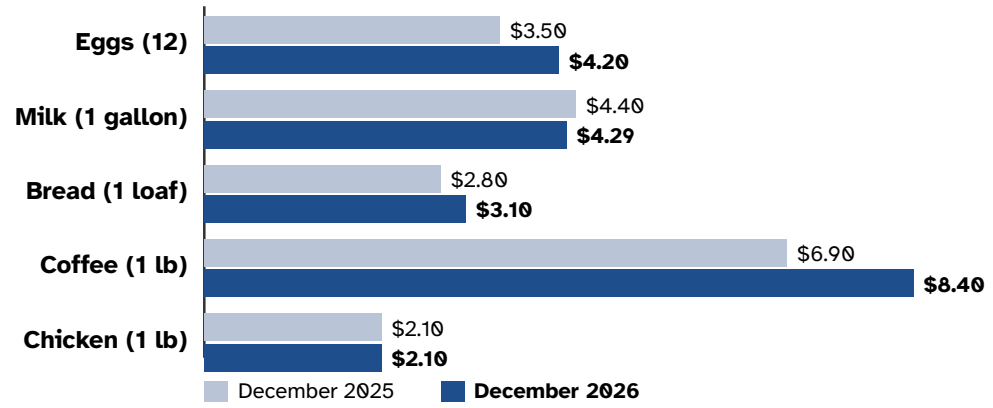
ANSWER KEY

EAST SIDE WEEKLY December 14, 2026 · Practice article: the newspaper, people, and prices are made up

Your Grocery Bill: What Costs More This Year?

Words to know

grocery bill = what you pay for food
a dozen = 12
economist = an expert on money and the economy
shopper = a person who shops
rise = go up
paycheck = the money you get for your work



1 Shoppers in East Side are talking about prices. “My **grocery bill** is bigger than last year,” says Maria Lopes, a mother of three. “I buy the same food, but I spend more.”

2 The *East Side Weekly* checked prices at three local stores in December 2025 and December 2026. Some foods are more expensive now. Coffee had the biggest change. A pound of coffee costs $1.50 more than last year.

3 Eggs are also more expensive. **A dozen** eggs costs $4.20 now. Last year, it was $3.50. But not everything costs more. Milk is a little cheaper than last year, and chicken is the same price.

4 Why do prices change? When prices **rise** for a long time, **economists** call it inflation. Weather, gas prices, and wages can all change food prices. “When coffee farms have a bad year, there is less coffee, so it is more expensive,” says a local store owner.

5 Wages matter too. If prices go up faster than wages, families can buy less with their **paychecks**. Maria has a plan. “I compare unit prices, and I buy rice and beans in bulk. It’s the cheapest way to feed my family.”

ANSWER KEY

STATION 3: READ News: grocery prices · with your group

First: Read the article alone. Read it **2 times**. Look at the chart too. Then answer.

Part A: Read the chart and the article

The answers are not always in one sentence. ★ = challenge.

1. Which food costs the most now? How much? **coffee, $8.40**
2. Which food had the biggest change? **coffee (+$1.50)**
3. Which food is cheaper than last year? **milk**
4. Which food is the same price? **chicken**
5. ★ Is bread cheaper or more expensive now? By how much?

More expensive: $3.10 – $2.80 = 30¢ more.

6. ★ Why can coffee get more expensive? (¶4)

When coffee farms have a bad year, there is less coffee.

7. ★ What does Maria do to save money? (¶5)

She compares unit prices and buys rice and beans in bulk.

Part B: Find the grammar

Find these in the article. Write the word.

-er than	more … than	the -est	a little / the same
bigger	**more expensive**	**the biggest / the cheapest**	**a little cheaper / the same price**

Part C: Talk together

1. What costs more now than last year for you?
2. What is the cheapest way to eat well? *“The cheapest way is …”*

You can say “Pass.” You never have to talk about your own money.

ANSWER KEY

STATION 4: REVIEW GAME fall review · with your group

How to play

1. Choose a **judge**. The judge holds the **answer sheet** (page 2 of the game sheet) and doesn't play.

2. Take turns. Choose a category and points: *"For / since, 200, please!"*

3. The judge reads the question. You answer **out loud**.

4. Right? You get the points. Wrong? Anyone can try for the points.

5. Cross off the square below. **New judge** every 5 questions.

Cross off the squares

Category	100	200	300
V2 / V3	100	200	300
If …	100	200	300
Can / should / must	100	200	300
Have you ever	100	200	300
Good at	100	200	300
For / since	100	200	300
Bigger / better	100	200	300

Scoreboard

Name	Points (add them up!)	Total

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STATION 4: REVIEW GAME fall review · with your group

My fall review

Use your own ideas. Finish the sentences about **your** fall in English class.

This fall, I have learned *answers vary: have + V3* .

Now I can *answers vary: can + V1* in English.

I'm good at *answers vary: + V-ing* , but I'm not good at *+ V-ing* yet.

The hardest thing for me was *answers vary* .

English is easier than *answers vary* now. 😊

Over the break, I should *answers vary: should + V1* .

If I practice every week, I will *answers vary: will + V1* .

What do you want to practice more?

Check **2**. Tell your teacher!

- ☐ V2 / V3
- ☐ Can / should / must
- ☐ Good at
- ☐ Bigger / better
- ☐ If ...
- ☐ Have you ever
- ☐ For / since

Share

Read your fall review to the person next to you. Then say one thing you liked about theirs.

ANSWER KEY

FINISHED EARLY? verb charts

Chart 1: Add the helping verbs

Write the **helping verb** in each blank. For negatives, use the short form (*doesn't*, *isn't*...). **Help:** Grammar Companion, **pages 11–12**.

Infinitive: to spend **Subject:** she

V1	V1-s	V-ing	V2	V3
spend	spends	spending	spent	spent

	Affirmative	Negative	Question
Present Simple	she spends	she doesn't spend	Does she spend?
Past Simple	she spent	she didn't spend	Did she spend?
Future Simple	she will spend	she won't spend	Will she spend?
Present Continuous	she is spending	she isn't spending	Is she spending?
Past Continuous	she was spending	she wasn't spending	Was she spending?
Future Continuous	she will be spending	she won't be spending	Will she be spending?
Present Perfect	she has spent	she hasn't spent	Has she spent?

Chart 2: Now you write it all

Write the 5 forms of **sell**. Then fill in the chart with **I**. **Help:** Grammar Companion, **page 9** (verb forms) and **pages 11–12** (tenses).

Infinitive: to sell **Subject:** I

V1	V1-s	V-ing	V2	V3
sell	**sells**	**selling**	**sold**	**sold**

	Affirmative	Negative	Question
Present Simple	**I sell**	**I don't sell**	**Do I sell?**
Past Simple	**I sold**	**I didn't sell**	**Did I sell?**
Future Simple	**I will sell**	**I won't sell**	**Will I sell?**
Present Continuous	**I am selling**	**I am not selling**	**Am I selling?**
Past Continuous	**I was selling**	**I wasn't selling**	**Was I selling?**
Future Continuous	**I will be selling**	**I won't be selling**	**Will I be selling?**
Present Perfect	**I have sold**	**I haven't sold**	**Have I sold?**